

with a metallic, slide-in cover. This prevented accidental contact with the disk surface. The irregular shape meant it could not be inserted incorrectly into the floppy drive.

This format was not without its problems, though. After gradual use, the metallic cover used to bend away from the surface of the disk, causing it to get stuck in the drive or not function when inserted into the computer. This has been improved upon by the introduction of plastic covers that replaced the metallic ones.

August: Better Graphics

Introduced for the first time on the IBM PC AT, EGA was launched in 1984. It included 16 KB ROM which handled all the graphics functions, and reduced the load on the BIOS. This standard was made obsolete with the introduction of the VGA standard in 1987.

1985

Games—Not To Forget DTP

March: Stallman Speaks

The president of the now-very-well-known Free Software Foundation, Richard Stallman, wrote the GNU Manifesto and published it in March of 1985. It was an explanation and description of the GNU Foundation—its ambitions, goals, and principles.

One of the basic principles of the GNU Foundation (GNU is short for “GNU’s Not UNIX”) is to provide free alternative software for proprietary programs and OSes. The GNU foundation also focuses on advocating the advantages of free software, and is involved in organising programmers to create free software for various OS platforms.

The GNU Manifesto is today used as a reference guide for the Free Software Foundation and its ideas are endorsed by the open source movement.